

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

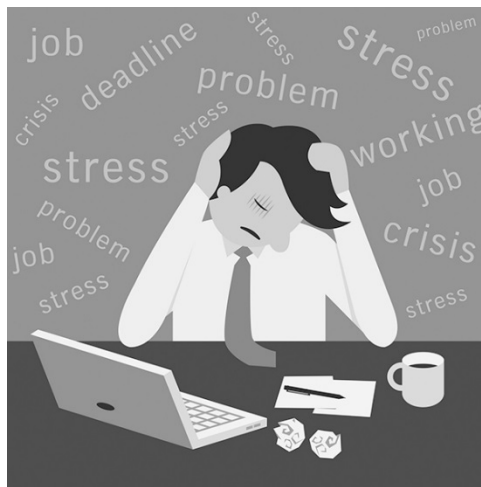
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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Peter is stressed out. Too much work and too little time!



Learning Outcome:

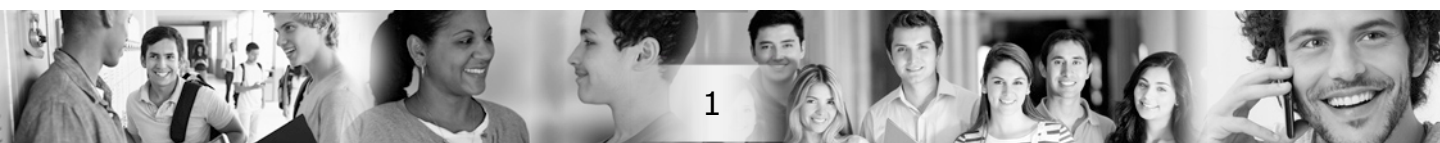
Identify and describe plans for the organization of events.

Can Do Statements:

- I can talk about subjects to study.
- I can use an essay outline.
- I can report about actions, events or people.

Ask your partner:

- Are you ever had too much to do?
Do you get stressed?
- What do you do to relax?





Let's Explore!

Peter is worried. His English essay is due shortly*. Listen to his conversation with Sally.

* "Shortly" means in a brief period of time.

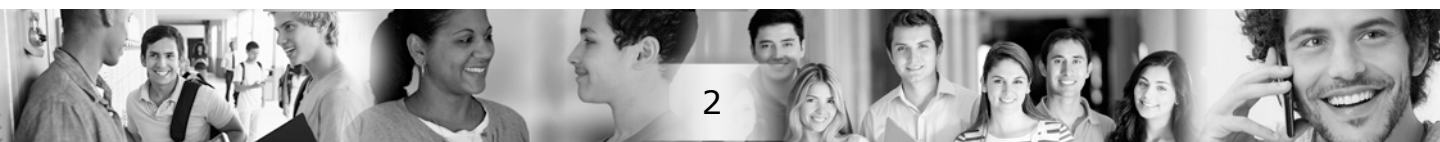


Instructions: Read the dialogue aloud.

Vanessa: What's the matter? You look upset.
Peter: I've got to write a final English paper for class. It's a 2000 word essay and I'm running out of time.
Sally: You look stressed out.
Peter: Between work and school, I'm being stretched too thin.

Vanessa: You need to look after yourself. I felt the same way at cooking school sometimes.
Peter: Yeah, and you weren't working at the same time. English essays require so much work!
Vanessa: Want some advice?
Peter: Sure.
Vanessa: Take a walk in the park and clear your head.

Peter: Alright.
Vanessa: Then, go home and have a hot shower. It will help you relax.
Peter: Ok, do you know how to write a great essay?
Vanessa: I have a lot of resources on my computer. When I get home, I'll e-mail you the information.
Peter: That sounds great! I really appreciate it.





Let's Practice!

Essay writing requires planning and structure.

Instructions: Choose all the correct answers.

1. What should you include in an essay?

- ☐ Introduction
- ☐ Informal language
- ☐ Conclusion
- ☐ Thesis
- ☐ Topic sentences
- ☐ Contractions



Let's Practice!

How does Sally plan help Peter with his assignment?

Instructions: Draw a line from the first part of the statement on the left to the second part on the right.

I've got to the write a final English

It's a 2000 word essay

I have a lot of resources

English essays require

Between work and school,

Take a walk in the par

and clear your head.

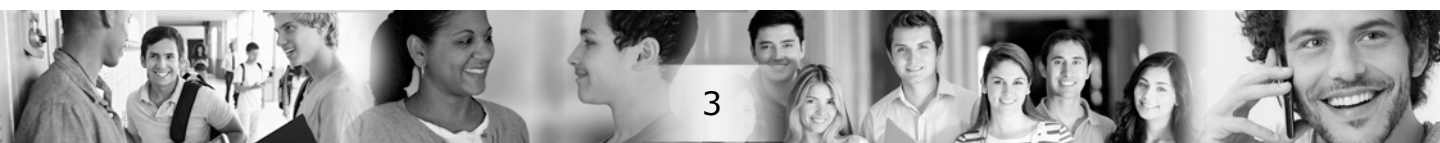
paper for class.

on my computer

I'm being stretched too thin.

so much work!

and I'm running out of time.





Extension Activity

Let's learn more about the structure of essays. It's time to do some research!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self Assessment.

- Go on the Internet.
- Find a simple English essay on a topic of your choice.
- Read the essay.
- Complete the essay outline below.

Topic:	
Thesis Statement	
What is the first paragraph about?	
What is the second paragraph about?	
What is the third paragraph about?	
What does the conclusion include?	
Which examples do it give to support the main points?	

Self Assessment

Yes No

I research ways to communicate through writing.

☐ ☐

I complete a table to show understanding.

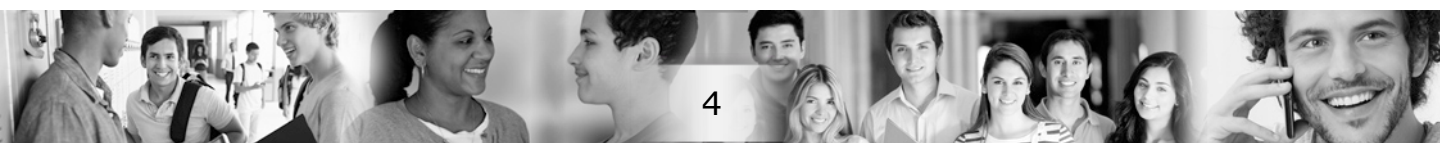
☐ ☐

I explain the main points of the essay to a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **stretched too thin** (expression): to be unable to complete tasks properly because of time
e.g. I'm being stretched too thin.
- **running out of** (expression): to not have enough time to complete something
e.g. I am running out of time to write my English essay.
- **advice** (noun): to not have enough time to complete something
e.g. Would you like some advice?
- **clear your head** (expression): to relax your mind
e.g. You need to go to the park and clear your head.
- **thesis** (noun): The sentence in an essay that tells the reader exactly what your paper will be arguing.
e.g. You have to include a thesis in your essay.





Learning Points

Elements of an Essay

Introduction: An introduction starts with general statements and then moves to your specific topic, ending in the thesis.

Thesis: Your introduction should end with a clear, specific thesis statement, which will tell readers what your paper will be arguing. Each body paragraph will directly and support your thesis.

Body Paragraphs: An essay usually has at least three body paragraphs, and these will be the arguments, evidence, or topics that support your thesis.

Topic Sentences: Each body paragraph will begin with a topic sentence which introduces its topic. All of the information in that paragraph will be related to that topic sentence.

Support: You use arguments, data, facts, analysis, examples, details, etc. to support your topic sentences. You should have at least three points to support each topic sentence.

Conclusion: A conclusion should wrap up your essay, it should not introduce new information or arguments. It should begin with a sentence that looks like your thesis and then draw your paper neatly to a close.

Using the Past Tense and Past Continuous Tense

You use the **past tense** when talking about actions that have already happened.

Examples:

- Yesterday, I ate potatoes for dinner.
- I bought these pants last week.

You use the past **continuous tense** when talking about actions in the past that happened for a period of time.

Examples:

- She was always talking during class.
- She was never on time for our meetings.

